

Weekly Session Plan

A hands-on, demo-first introduction to AI for the whole organization

Design principle

Every session pairs a short live demo (Claude does it, attendees watch) with a hands-on activity (attendees do it themselves, on their own laptop, with their own real task where possible). Slides are kept to under 10 minutes per session — the rest is doing, not watching.

PHASE 1

Foundations

Weeks 1-4 — get everyone speaking the same language

#	Session	Format	Attendees leave able to...
1	Demystifying AI <i>AI vs. ML vs. generative vs. agentic — plain-language map</i>	DEMO Ask the same question to a search engine vs. Claude/ChatGPT side by side. HANDS-ON Every attendee opens an approved AI tool and runs one prompt about their own work.	Explain the difference between AI terms without jargon
2	How LLMs actually work <i>Tokens, context windows, why confident answers can be wrong</i>	DEMO Trigger a hallucination live — ask a tricky, obscure factual question and show the confident wrong answer. HANDS-ON Pairs try to make the tool hallucinate on a topic they know well, then compare notes.	Spot a likely hallucination before trusting it
3	The AI tool landscape <i>What's approved/licensed at our org, and what each tool is good at</i>	DEMO Run the identical task (e.g. summarize a doc) across 2-3 approved tools live, compare outputs. HANDS-ON Attendees run their own sample task on two tools and vote on which did better.	Pick the right tool for a given task
4	Prompting 101 <i>Being specific, giving context, iterating, using examples</i>	DEMO Live before/after: a vague prompt vs. a refined one, same task, visibly different quality. HANDS-ON Everyone rewrites one of their own vague prompts and re-runs it; share the improvement.	Write a prompt that gets a usable answer on the first try

PHASE 2

Practical Skills

Weeks 5-8 — use it well and safely in the day job

#	Session	Format	Attendees leave able to...
5	AI for everyday productivity <i>Email drafts, meeting summaries, research, brainstorming</i>	DEMO Draft a real email/summary live from a messy set of notes. HANDS-ON Each attendee brings one real task (an email, a summary, an agenda) and completes it live with AI.	Save real time on one recurring task this week
6	Critical thinking with AI	DEMO	Verify an AI answer

	Verifying outputs, spotting bias, knowing when not to trust it	Fact-check a hallucinated or biased answer live, showing how to catch it. HANDS-ON Spot-the-error exercise: pairs review 3 AI answers, one of which is subtly wrong, and find it.	before acting on it
7	Data privacy: what NOT to paste into AI <i>PII, confidential docs, client data, IP — org-specific examples</i>	DEMO Show a redaction/masking approach and what happens when sensitive data is pasted into a public tool. HANDS-ON Attendees sort a set of real-style examples into 'safe to paste' vs. 'never paste'.	Recognize what's off-limits before it becomes a habit
8	Prompt engineering, level 2 <i>Chaining prompts, role-based prompting, structured outputs</i>	DEMO Chain 2–3 prompts live to take raw notes to a structured table or report. HANDS-ON Attendees chain their own 2-step task (e.g. summarize then convert to bullet action items).	Break a multi-step task into a prompt chain

PHASE 3

The Shift to Agentic AI

Weeks 9–11 — from chatbot thinking to agent thinking

#	Session	Format	Attendees leave able to...
9	From chatbots to agents <i>The core distinction: agents plan, act, and use tools toward a goal</i>	DEMO Watch an agent complete a real multi-step task live (e.g. research + compile + summarize, unattended). HANDS-ON Attendees give an agent one open-ended goal and observe/narrate its steps together.	Explain what makes a tool 'agentic' vs. just generative
10	Agentic AI in the wild <i>Real, varied examples of agents already at work across industries</i>	DEMO Live-run 2–3 short agent demos (e.g. an agent that researches, one that automates a workflow). HANDS-ON Small groups sketch one agentic use case for a task they personally find tedious.	Identify a real candidate task for an agent in their own work
11	Human-in-the-loop: where AI should (and shouldn't) act alone <i>Autonomy levels, approval gates, audit trails</i>	DEMO Show an agent attempt an irreversible action and where a human-approval gate stops it. HANDS-ON Attendees design an approval rule for a sample workflow (what needs sign-off, what doesn't).	Set a sensible autonomy boundary for an agent

PHASE 4

Domain Deep-Dive: Data Engineering

Week 12 — agentic AI applied to a specific function, in depth

#	Session	Format	Attendees leave able to...
12	AI for Data Engineering & Analytics <i>Pipelines, quality, governance, migration, NL-to-SQL — market evidence + real case studies</i>	DEMO Live NL-to-SQL query against a real/sample dataset; live pipeline-code generation with a copilot. HANDS-ON Attendees write one plain-English question and watch an agent	Try one agentic tool on their own data task

turn it into a working query or pipeline step.

PHASE 5

Culture & Trajectory

Ongoing, monthly — sustaining the habit and addressing the real questions

#	Session	Format	Attendees leave able to...
1 3	AI ethics & responsible use <i>Fairness, bias, accountability, when to escalate</i>	DEMO Walk through a real biased-output example and how it was caught. HANDS-ON Small-group discussion of 2–3 org-relevant ethics scenarios; groups report back.	Know when and how to raise a concern
1 4	The future of your role <i>Career evolution: from executor to orchestrator; addressing 'will this replace me' directly</i>	DEMO Show the maturity-ladder framework with real role-evolution examples. HANDS-ON Attendees self-place on the ladder and write one action to move up a rung.	Leave with a personal next step, not just reassurance
1 5	Hands-on lab / mini hackathon <i>Build something small, live, with guidance</i>	DEMO Facilitator builds one small automation start-to-finish as a model. HANDS-ON Attendees build (or start) their own small agent/automation for a real task, with support on hand.	Have a working prototype, however small
1 6	Internal showcase <i>A team that's shipped something with AI presents their story</i>	DEMO Guest team demos their real, working solution live. HANDS-ON Q&A + attendees identify one idea from the showcase to try themselves.	See a peer-proven example, not just a vendor one

Cadence note: run Phases 1–3 weekly without skipping — they build on each other. Phase 4 can slot in once Phase 3 lands. Phase 5 sessions work well spaced out monthly once the weekly cadence winds down, to keep momentum without fatigue.